

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

The following is an extract from a blog:

What Ever Happened to World Class Customer Service?

Hong Kong risks losing its competitive edge if the quality of its customer service continues to decline. "The customer is king" means providing quality service to customers so that they get the best experience. However, cases of bad customer service are becoming more frequent.

There was the case of the waiter who angrily said again and again, "THERE ARE NO MORE SEATS" when I wanted to book a table. "What about the waiting list?" I asked. He said that there was no room on the waiting list. Then there was the case when I called a company and had to go through their automated phone system and it took forever to get my question answered. It was only after a very long wait that I was able to finally speak with an actual person. When I finally got someone on the phone, they acted as though they were doing me a favor by answering my inquiry.

To improve customer service, the major focus has to be placed on the employees to make sure they are treated equally and that they work in an environment that is motivating, inspiring and encouraging. Employees should be given a word of praise whenever possible. Every attempt possible should be made to motivate employees by rewarding them for a difficult job done well. With these measures in place, we should see world class customer service return to Hong Kong once again.

Your group wants to collect opinions from your schoolmates for a group project about customer service in Hong Kong. You may want to talk about:

- why good customer service is important
- whether or not customer service in Hong Kong is getting worse
- how customer service can be improved
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Would you like to work in a restaurant?
2. Is good customer service more important in a restaurant or a clothes shop?
3. Would you complain if you experienced bad customer service?
4. How can shop assistants give a good impression to tourists in Hong Kong?
5. Would you recommend a restaurant despite bad customer service?
6. Do you think you could deal with rude customers if you worked in a shop?
7. Should service industry employees be given more respect?
8. How can employees be motivated to improve the way they treat customers?